

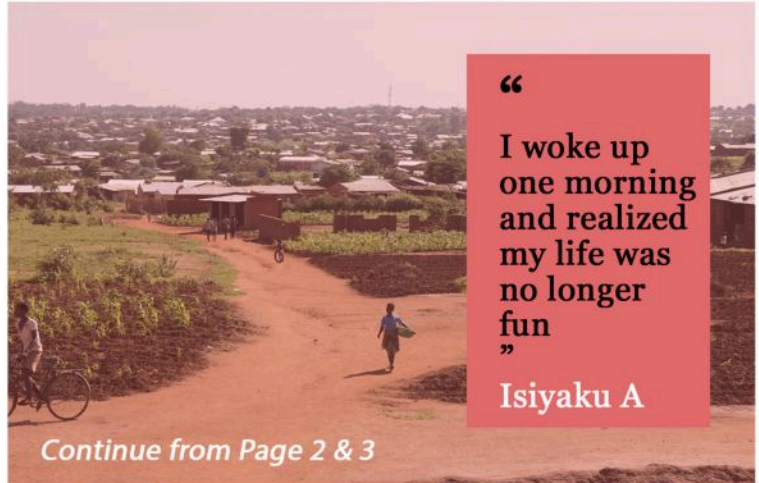
September, 2022

HELPERS DIGEST

EDUCATION - HEALTH - GOVERNANCE - GENDER - SOCIAL ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT - AGRICULTURE

BRINGING BACK MY INNER PEACE

The word ABUSE brings different images to the minds of different people. It can be difficult to let go with no intervention. Drug abuse among youths increases the risk of problems related to their well-being and health, resulting in an increased risk of injury and death from interpersonal violence, road accidents, risky sexual behaviors, diseases such as acquired immune deficiency syndrome (AIDS), and academic problems.



A JOURNEY OF A MILE BEGINS WITH A STEP

A helping hand does not need to be big; a step can be a mile. Yobe State has faced severe disruption of its health service as a result of insurgency. A systems dynamics analysis was conducted to identify key pathways of

response and adaptation. A lot of health facilities were affected which led to the rebuilding and restructuring of health facilities. It is said health is wealth and he that has life has everything.

Agriculture is a key to economic drive; it is also central to poverty



alleviation and economic growth. People depend on it for a wider range of production, livelihood, and existence. Agriculture is also key to a healthy environment.

Dumsai PHC has workers who are not just passionate about their jobs

“
it a duty to complete the journey of a thousand-mile with a big step.
”

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BRINGING BACK MY INNER PEACE

To society, it will lead to an unfavorable impact or an increase in the crime rate. Addictions resort to crime to pay for their drugs. Drugs remove inhibition and impair judgment, egging one on to commit offenses.



Isiyaku Adamu is a 20years old youth who lives in a community called Dapchi local government Yobe State Nigeria, a secondary school dropout, who was unable to further his education due to finance. Although he had a choice to live right, he could not fight peer pressure. With time he began to associate and mingle with bad companies who thought, lured, and indulged him. He wallowed in that act for a while, which he claims brings him inner peace, his parents were worried about losing him but he was never worried about losing himself. The community members call him Dantahada (thug). He was so proud of his life, fully dedicated, and committed to drugs, feared by the community members, until the encounter. In his word, he said

"I woke up one morning and realized my life was no longer fun, watching my age mates getting married and having families, and businesses of their own made me stop to think, what if I give change a try? So going out I met a longtime friend Isa Bawa, who told me he is part of a peer educators group organized by an organization called PLAN& LHI, the group has changed his life and he will like to change mine".

Plan international {BMZ} in collaboration with Life Helper's Initiative (LHI) established an Adolescent and Youth friendly center to enable them access to counseling youths, the group holds' a male CBHV (community health volunteer) council and Isa is a member of the group who referred Isiyaku, for appropriate services which changed his life.

Isa further introduces him to a local business of vegetables, making sure he can fend for

BRINGING BACK MY INNER PEACE

himself and his family, he also started teaching him how to read and write; although Isa was an O'level graduate he can read and write, dedicating his time to making sure Isiyaku have a responsible life. The transition was not easy for Isiyaku but the change was great, no decrease in appetite and undernourishment, he sleeps well, he takes proper care of himself, there was no violence, and takes care of his responsibilities at home. With constant follow up Isiyaku is now drug-free and his friends were able to raise funds to enroll him back in school, with the help of the group. Isaiyaku in his words exclaimed with JOY, this the journey of my inner peace!!!!

A JOURNEY OF A MILE BEGINS WITH A STEP

and career but also makes it a duty to complete the journey of a thousand-mile with a big step. PLAN project brought about a great change to the community of Dumsai and its primary health facility (PHC Dumsai) by building a section of the facility. This building was a great start of bigger development for the community because their major issues were lack of space and drugs. It was a struggle for the workers at the facility and community as the means of how to get support, was not forthcoming. The issue of lack of drugs became a major setback to the facility and also increases the problem of lack of proper medical attention to patients and emergencies not being handled on time which leads to the deaths of many. The health damage kept growing, bringing about pain to the community, and issues of fake drugs or wrong drugs prescription became the order of the day.



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A JOURNEY OF A MILE BEGINS WITH A STEP

With the help of the PLAN BMZ project to promote social cohesion through the rehabilitation of social infrastructure and the integration of IDPs (Internal Displaced Persons) and refugees, Dumsai PHC facility staff grew a garden to sell to help save, in other to procure drugs as the project is closing out and also help to reduce the rate of health damages caused as a result of the setback highlighted above in the community.

The decision they too have not only helped the community but also helped in the continued growth of the outreach they have been conducting for sustainability after the project. The community members are happy with the giant step and they all agreed to form a group with the help of some health workers to keep giving their support because everything is possible with a step.



Tayo Fatinikun

Joy Dauda Dogo

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LIFE HELPERS INITIATIVE

Putting a smile on a face

OUR MISSION

To be a leading non-governmental organisation, empowering children, youths, women and communities, to live maximally in all aspect of life through advocacy, capacity development initiatives, community mobilization and social economic development.

OUR VISION

A more fulfilled life for every person

OUR VALUES

- Love -** Friendly Atmosphere, Togetherness, Kind Gestures
- HONESTLY -** Openness, Forthrightness
- INTERGRITY -** Equity, Matching our words with our Actions; Acceptance; Access; Opportunity for staffs and clients.



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